

Activity Guide 2

Last updated by | Jake Kappus | Mar 30, 2023 at 11:50 AM MDT

Building a Report in the Power BI Service

This activity walks you through creating a simple report with several visuals using data from an Excel file.

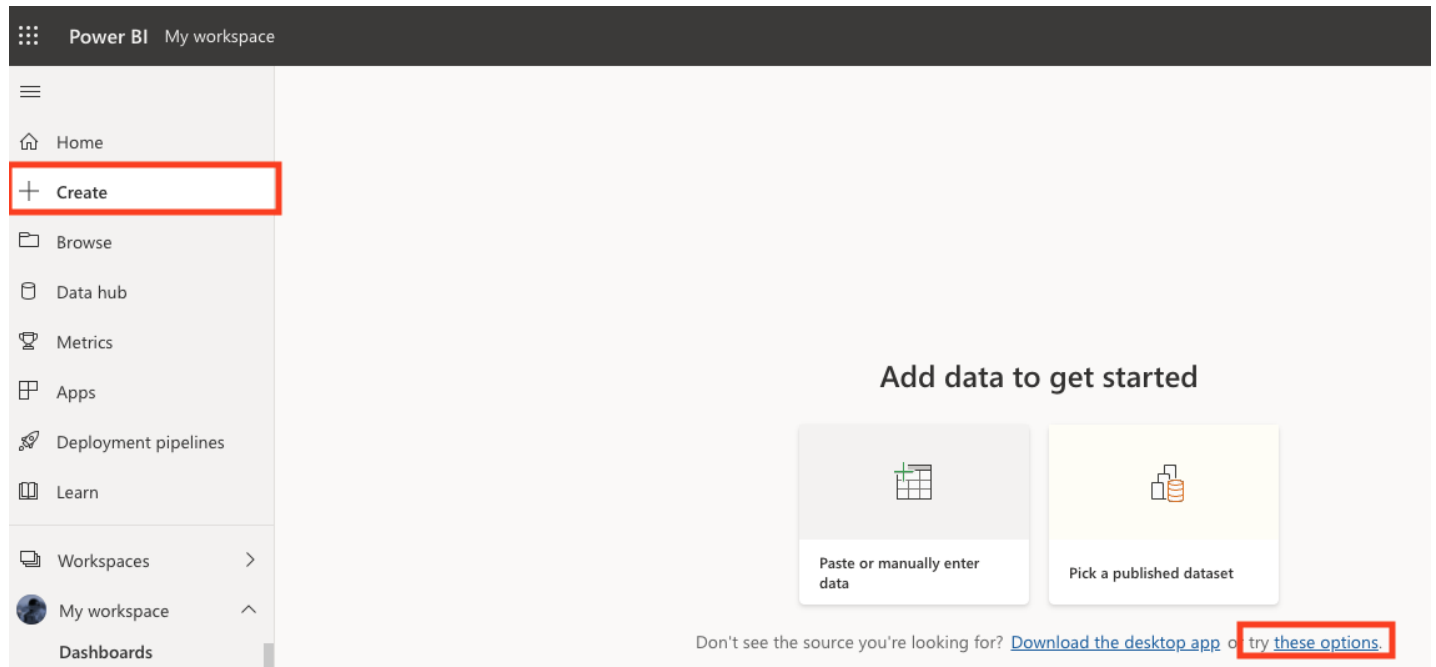
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Get your data from +Create

1. Open and sign into your tenant's [Power BI Web Portal](#) 
(For **DOD** the URL is: <https://app.mil.powerbigov.us> )
2. From the Home page, click on **+ Create**

If the **+ Create** screen looks like this:



Then click **try these options** and then skip to [the next section in this guide](#)

If the **+ Create** screen looks like this:

Add data to get started



Paste or manually enter data

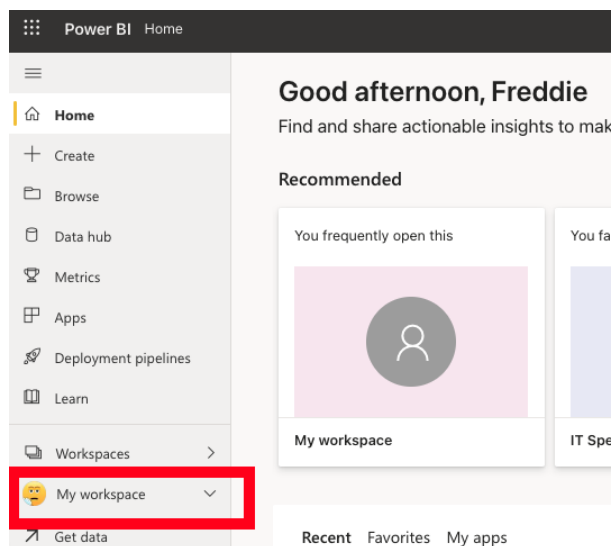


Pick a published dataset

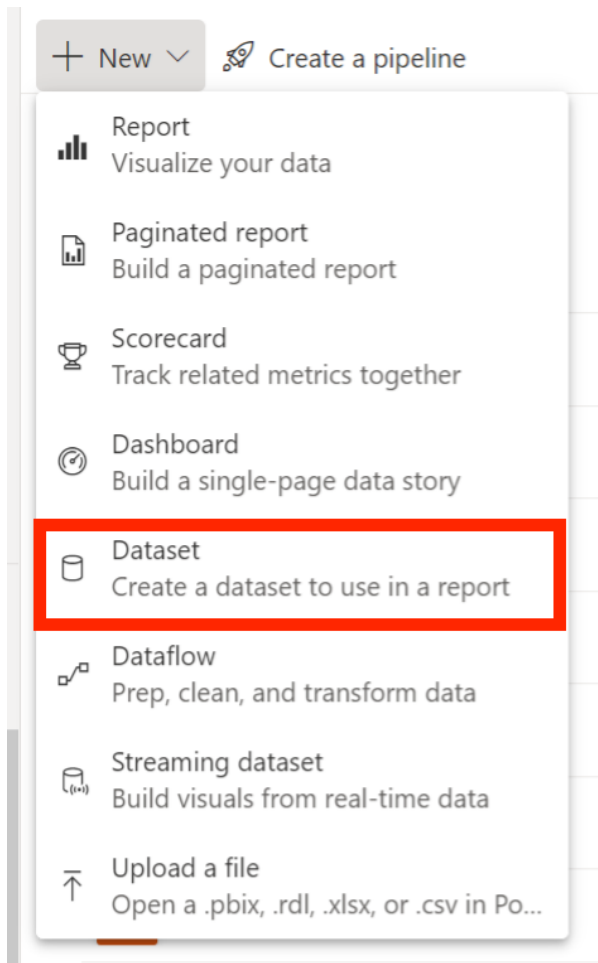
Don't see the source you're looking for? [Download the desktop app](#).

Then follow these directions to import a local file into Power BI:

a. Click on **My Workspace**



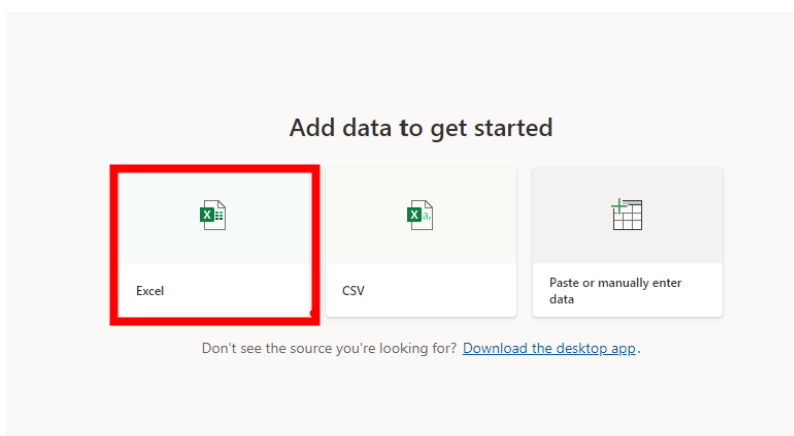
b. Select **New** then **Dataset**



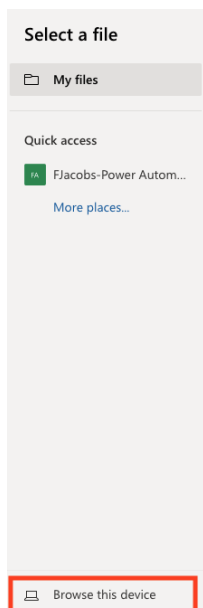
Continue on with the next section.

Import File

1. Click **Excel**



2. On the *Select a file* screen, click on **Browse this device**



3. Choose the **Power BI Training Data - Personnel.xlsx** file

	 Name ▾	Modified ▾
	Power BI Training Data - Assets.xlsx	January 29
	 Power BI Training Data - Personnel.xlsx	January 29
	Power BI Training Data - Training.xlsx	January 29

4. Under **Visualize this data** click on **+Create a Report**.

then choose **Start from Scratch**

Power BI Training Data - Training ▾

File ▾ Refresh ▾ Share + Create a report ▾ Analyze in Excel Lineage ▾ ...

Dataset details

 **Workspace**
My Workspace

 **Refreshed**
3/30/23, 9:35:24 AM

Description  [Add a description](#)

 **Visualize this data**
Create an interactive report, or a table, to discover and share business insights. [Learn more](#)

+ Create a report ▾

Auto-create

Start from scratch

Paginated report

 **Share this data**
Give people access to the dataset and set their permissions to work with it. [Learn more](#)

Share dataset

5. On the *Add data to get started* page click **Excel**

Add data to get started

 **Excel**

 CSV

 Paste or manually enter data

Don't see the source you're looking for? [Download the desktop app.](#)

6. On the *Select a file* screen, click on **Browse this device**

Select a file

My files

Quick access

FJacobs-Power Autom...

More places...

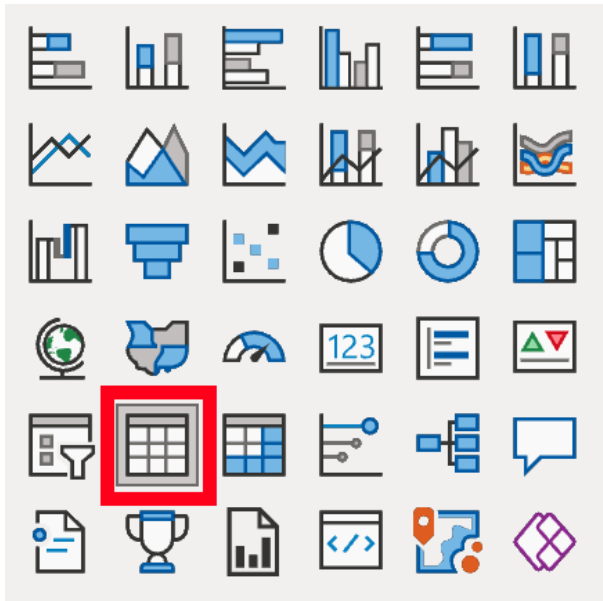
Browse this device

7. Choose the **Power BI Training Data - Personnel.xlsx** file

	 Name ▾	Modified ▾
	Power BI Training Data - Assets.xlsx	January 29
	 Power BI Training Data - Personnel.xlsx	January 29
	Power BI Training Data - Training.xlsx	January 29

Layout your visuals: Table

1. In your blank report, under **Visualizations**, click on the Table visual

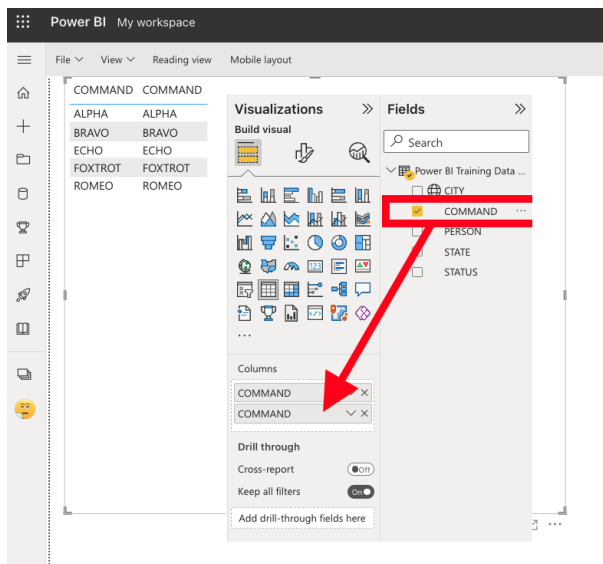


2. This visual will show a count of each person in a command

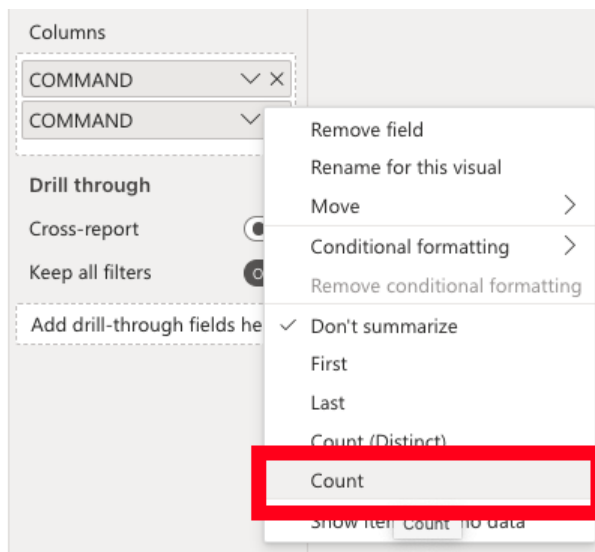
Select the checkbox next to the **Command** Field.

Notice only the *Command* names are listed in the table. Therefore, in order to accomplish our goal of creating a count of the command we will need to also drag the **"COMMAND"** Field to the **Columns** section in the Visualizations pane. To do this click on the word **"COMMAND"** and pull it down underneath the current **"COMMAND"**

 You will see Command twice in Columns section of Visualizations pane.



Now, we need to get the actual count of each person in the Command. On the **Second COMMAND** you just placed under **Columns**. Click on the **down arrow (V)** and change it to **Count**.



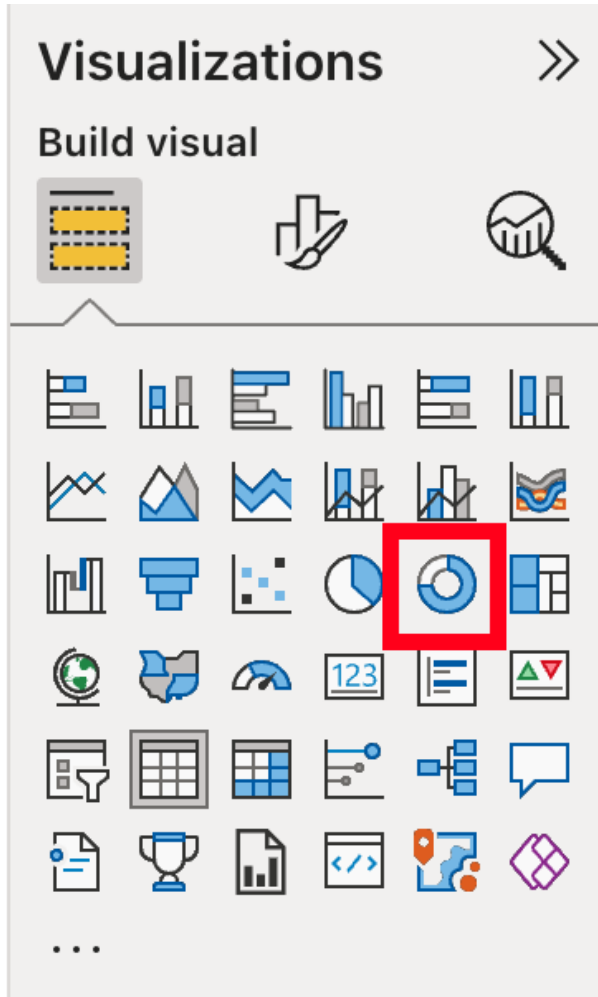
Your table will now display a count for each command.

COMMAND	Count of COMMAND
ALPHA	31
BRAVO	52
ECHO	39
FOXTROT	20
ROMEO	30
Total	172

Layout your visuals: Donut chart

Tables are great, but everyone loves to see colorful charts that make it easy to interpret data quickly. Let's change that table into a Donut chart.

1. To change the table to a donut chart click and select the table, then under *Visualizations*, select the **Donut chart** visual.

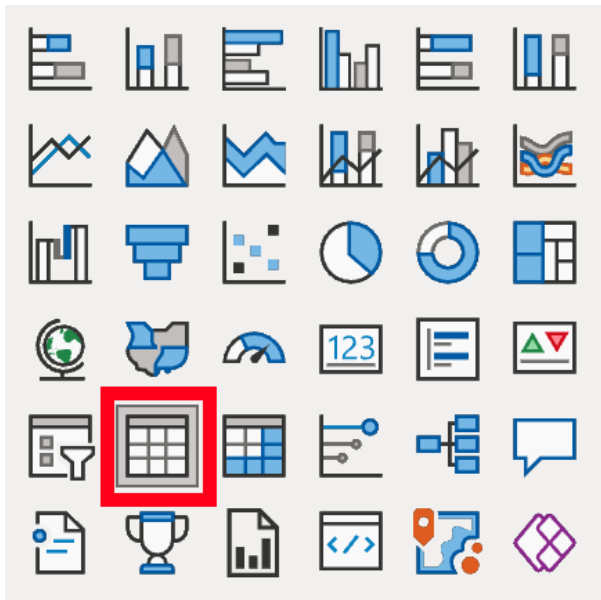


2. Click on a blank area of the report

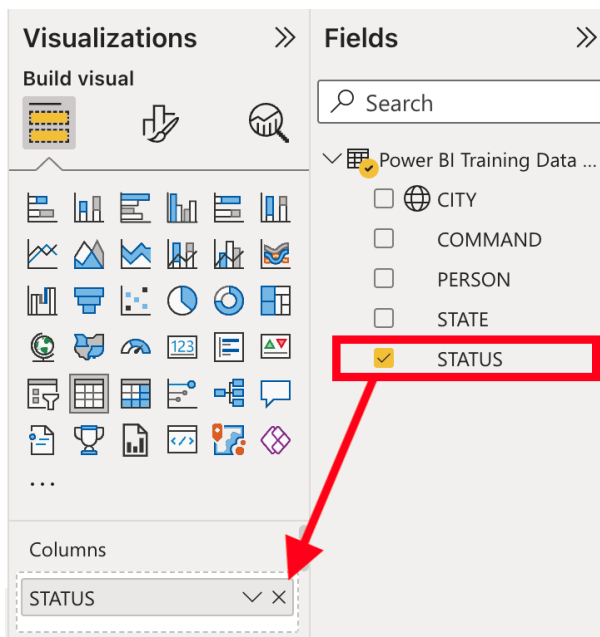
Note: The table will change to a visual of a Donut chart.

Clicking on a blank area of the report will ensure when another visual or field is selected, the visual does not change.

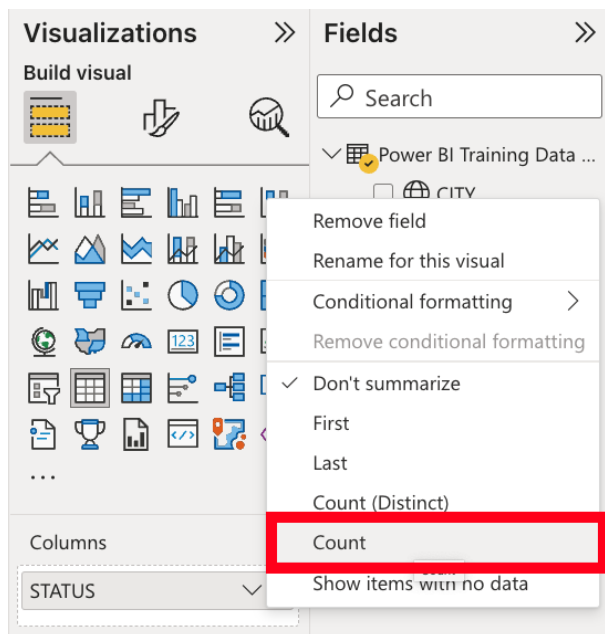
3. Select the **Table visual** again



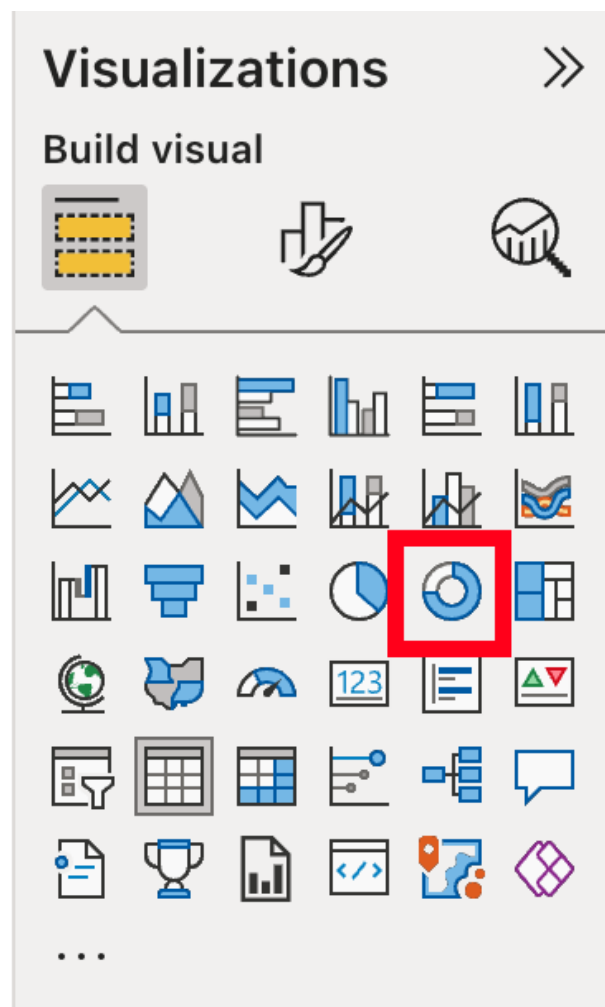
4. Under **Data**, click the **STATUS** field and drag the **STATUS** field under **Columns** in the *Visualizations* pane.



5. Under **Columns** on **STATUS** Click on the **down arrow (V)** and change it to **Count**.

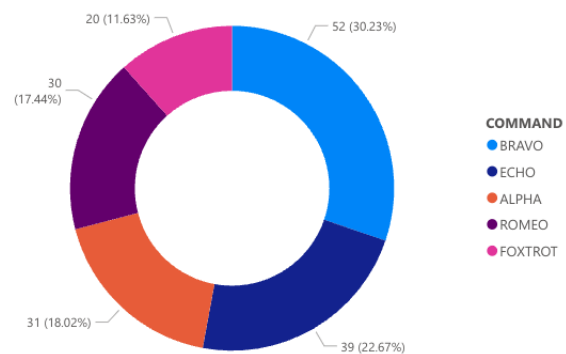


6. Click and select your table, then under *Visualizations*, select the Donut chart visual.



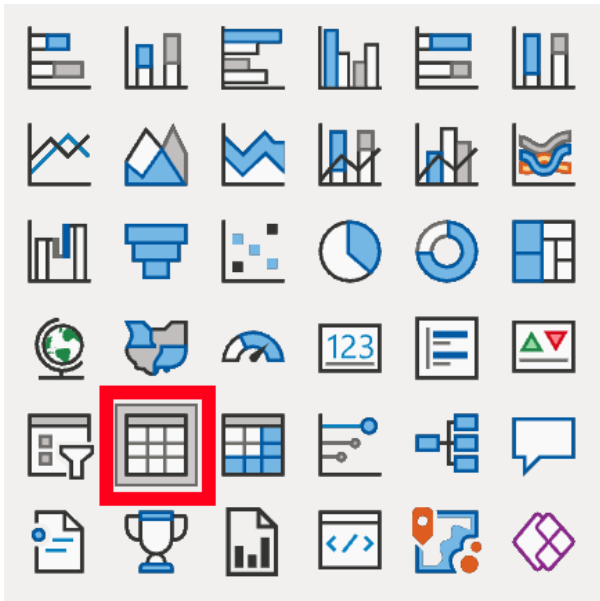
The Donut chart now shows the number of people in that *STATUS* per *COMMAND*.

Count of COMMAND by COMMAND

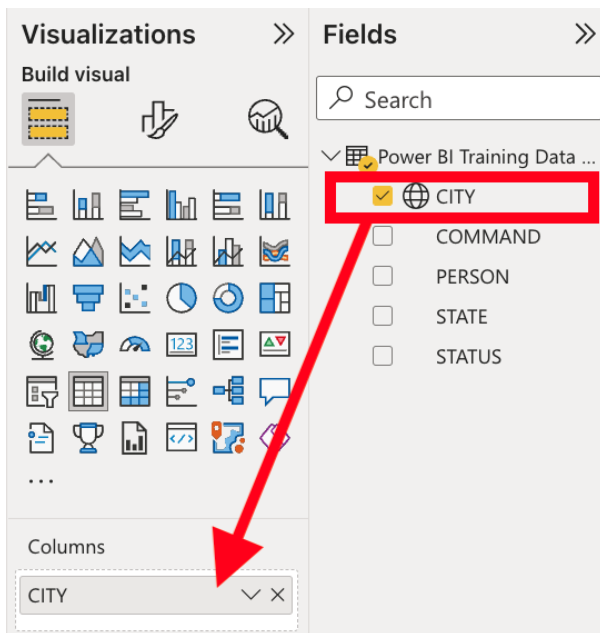


Layout your visuals: Tree Map

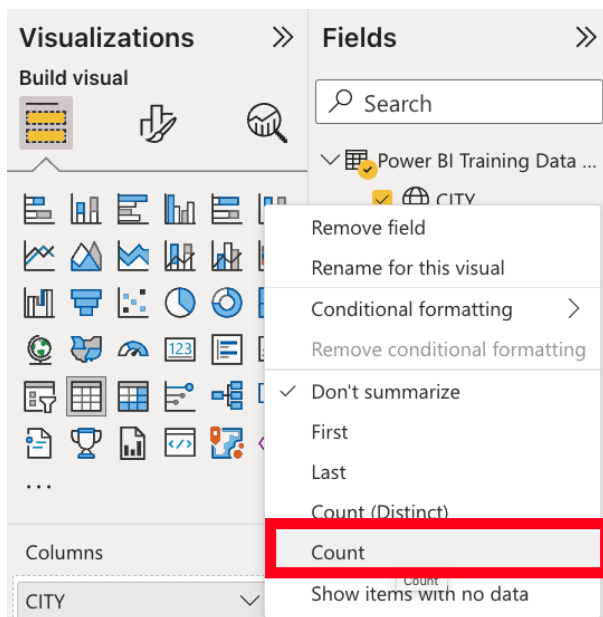
1. Let's add a new visual by clicking in the whitespace of the report. Select the **Table visual** again



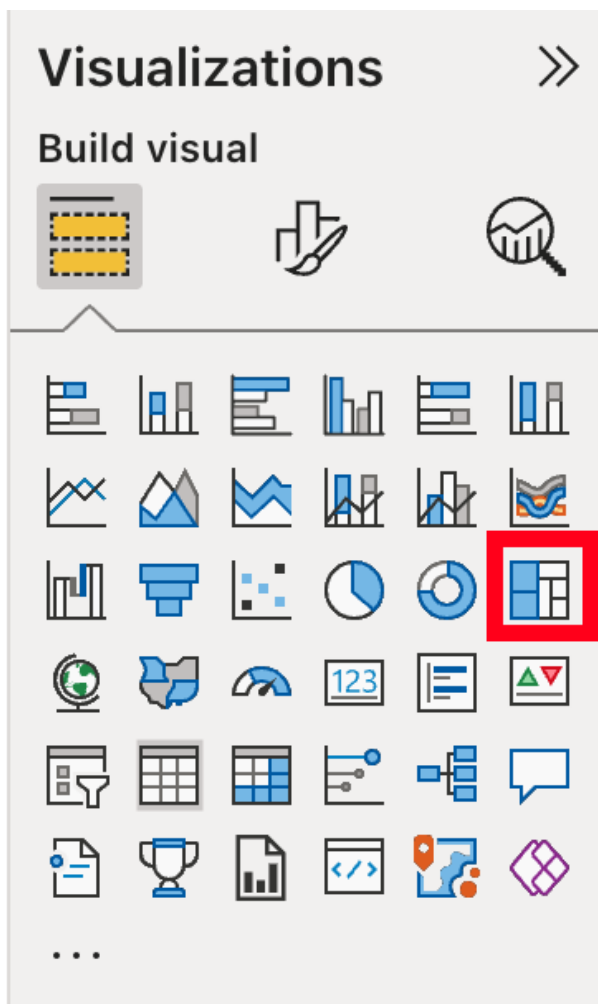
2. Under **Data**, click the **CITY** field checkbox and then drag another **CITY** field under **Columns** in the *Visualizations* pane. (There should now be two)



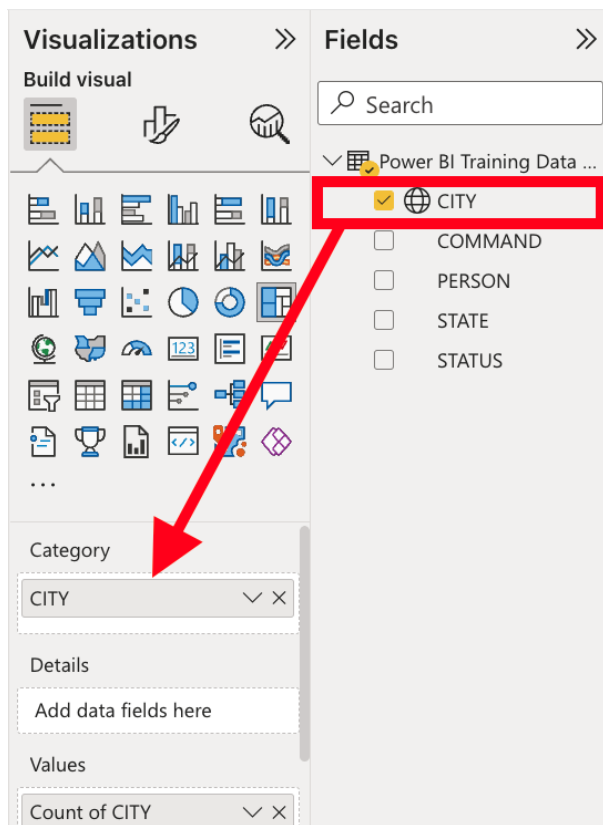
3. Under **Columns** on **CITY** Click on the **down arrow (V)** and change it to **Count**.



4. Click and select your table, then under *Visualizations*, select the **Tree Map** chart visual.

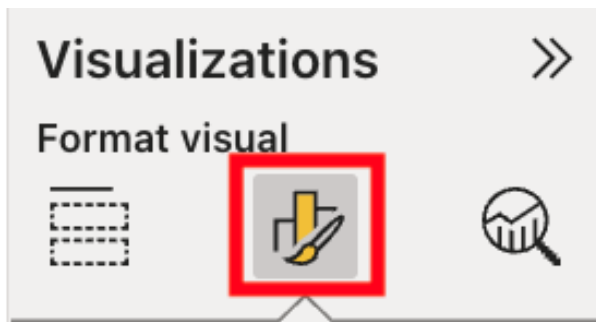


5. We want this visual to show the amount of people in each CITY so the *Visualizations* pane should look like the image below.



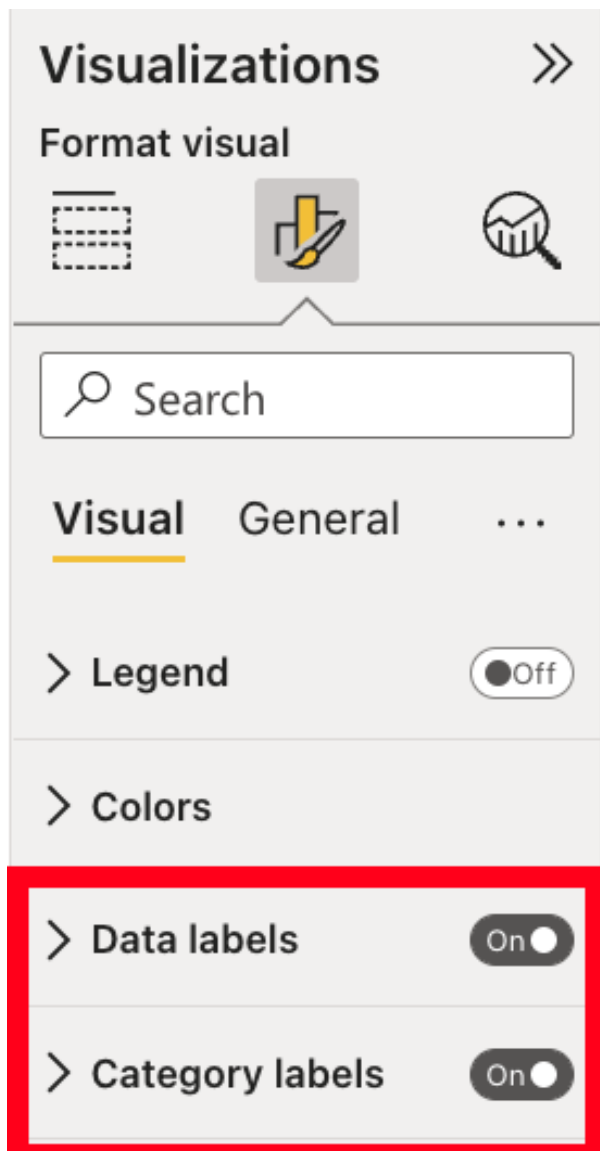
This is great, but it would be easier to understand with the number and a legend to describe what this visual is telling us.

6. Click and select your table, then under *Visualizations*, select the **Format Visual** icon (in the middle).

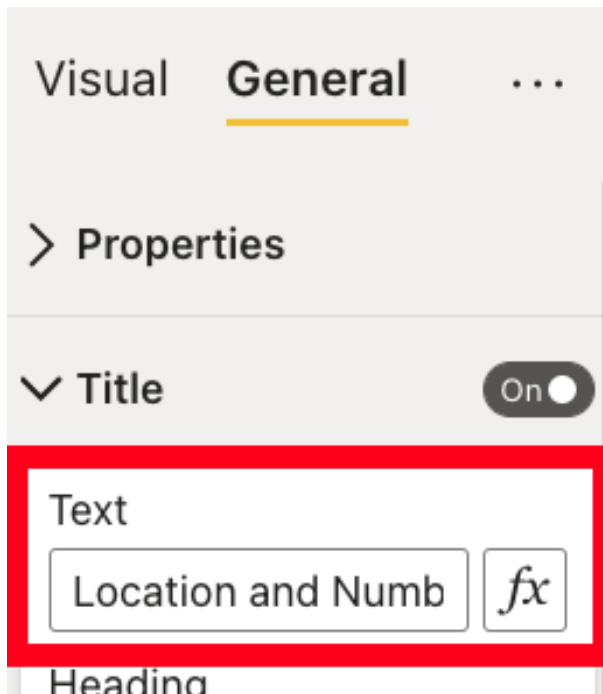


7. Next to **Data labels** toggle the button to **On**

Then next to **Category labels** toggle the button to **On**

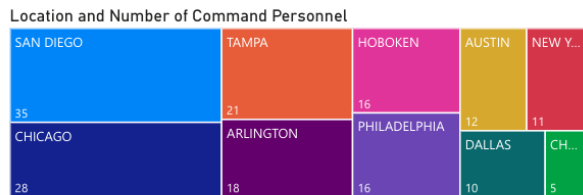


8. While we are here, let's give this visual a proper name. Under **Format Visual**, click on **General**.
Then click **the arrow (>)** next to **Title**



Under **Text** change that to something more meaningful like "***Location and Number of Command Personnel***"

Your map should now have a nice, descriptive title.



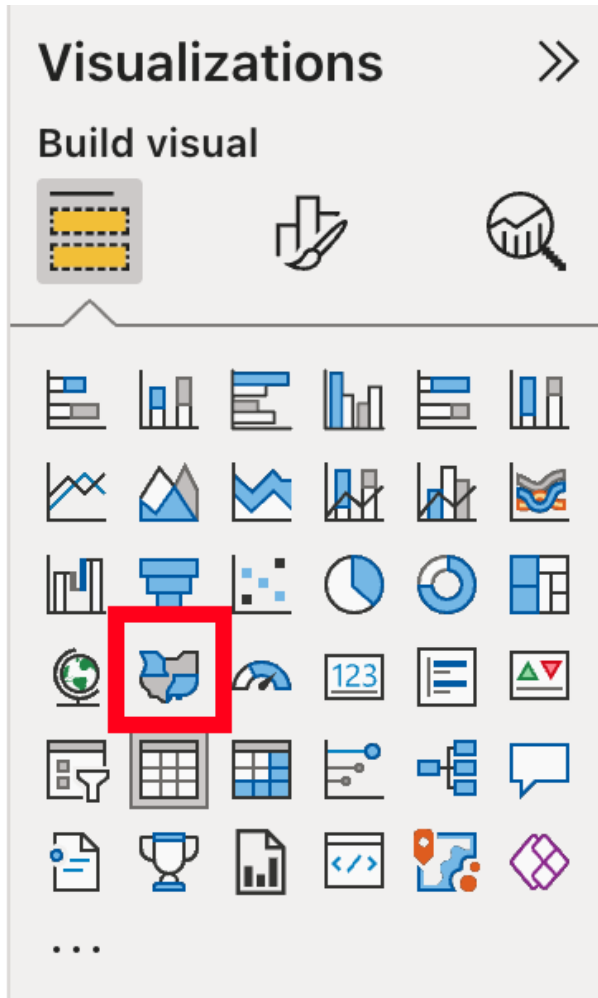
Layout your visuals: Filled Map

Let's add an actual map that displays the locations of our Personnel on a map.

1. Click on blank area of the report

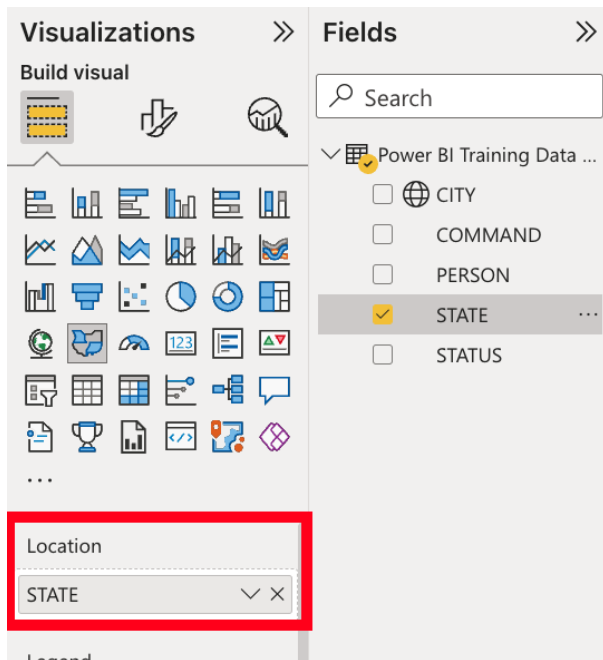
Under *Visualizations*, select the **Filled Map** visual

 **Hint!** It looks a lot like the state of Ohio!



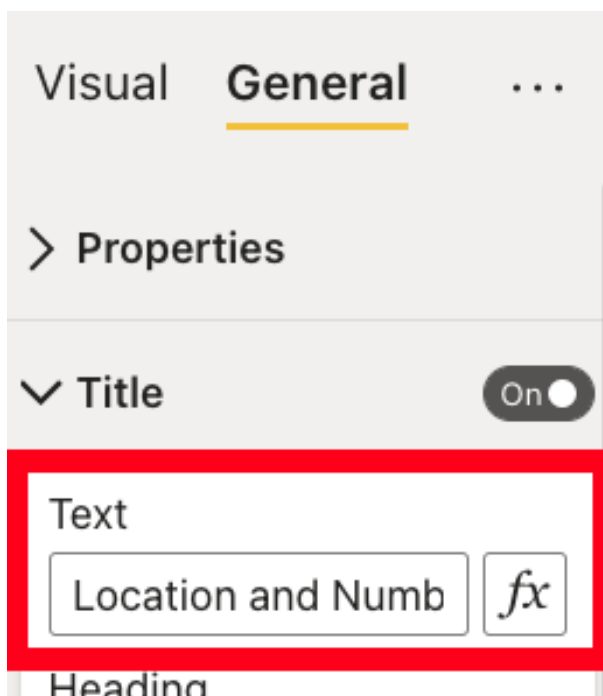
2. With the Filled Map selected, Under **Data**, click on **STATE**.

STATE should now be populated under *Location* in the *Visualizations* section.

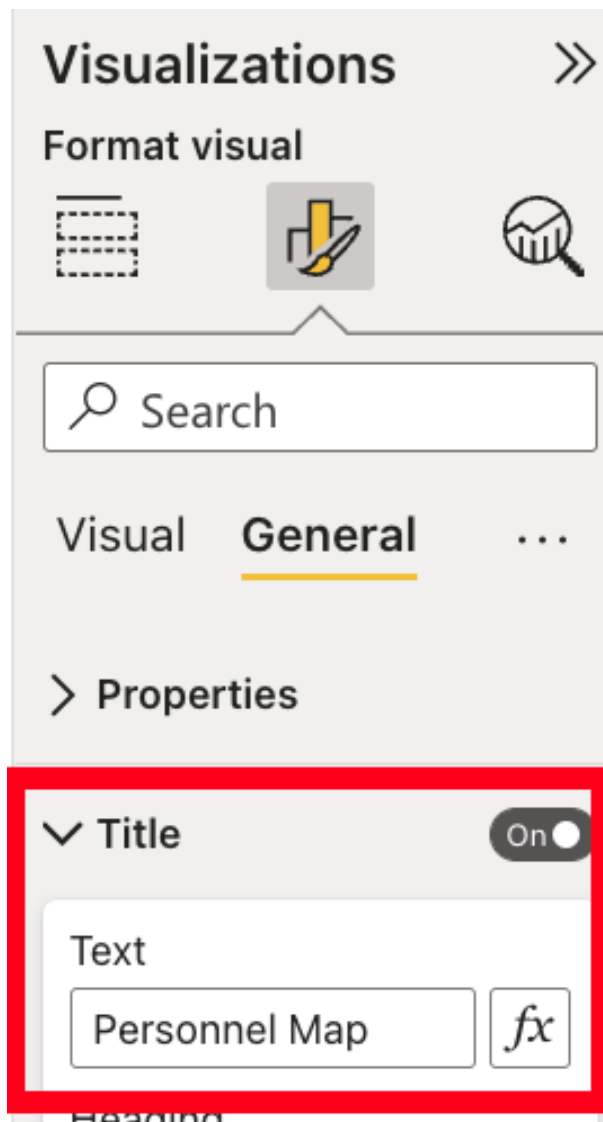


3. While we are here, let's give this visual a proper name. Under **Format Visual**, click on **General**.

Then click **the arrow (>)** next to **Title**



Under **Text** change that to something more meaningful like "***Personnel Map***"



Your map should now have a nice, descriptive title.

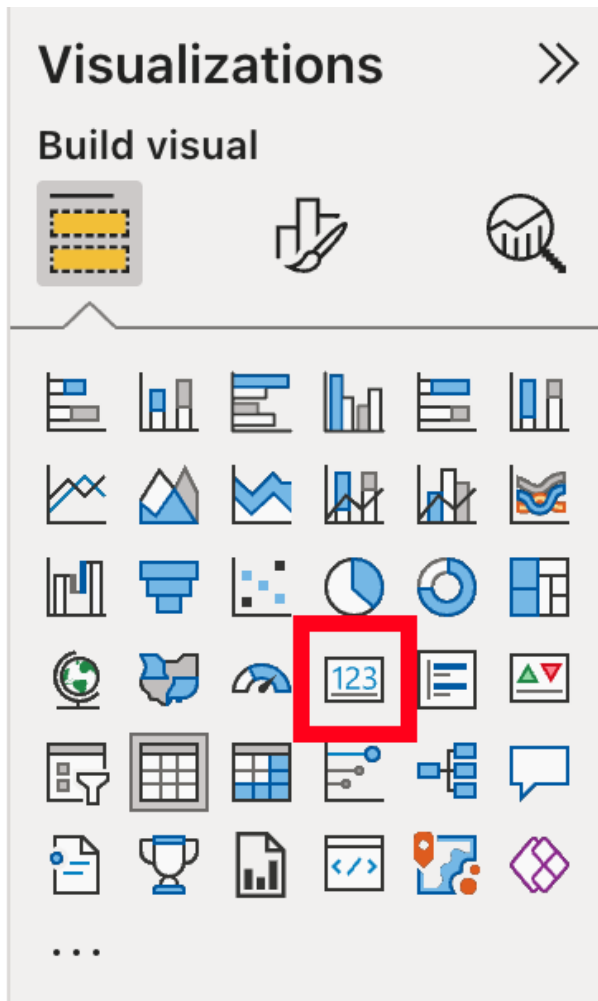


Layout your visuals: Card Visual

Sometimes just a simple number or statistic is all you need to make impact on the consumer of this report. Let's add a simple card that shows the number of personnel that are in *AWOL* status.

1. Click on blank area of the report

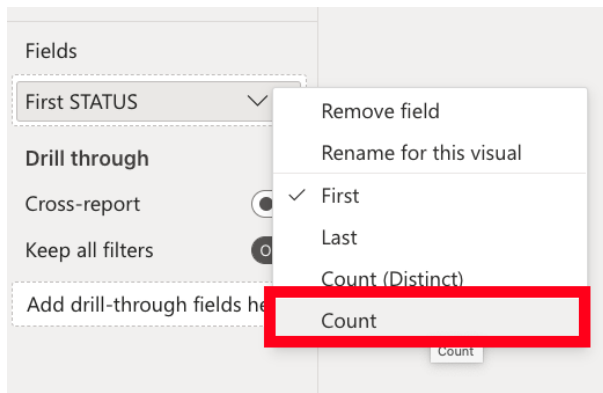
Under *Visualizations*, select the **Card** visual



2. With the new **Card** visual selected in the report, Under **Data**, click on **STATUS**.

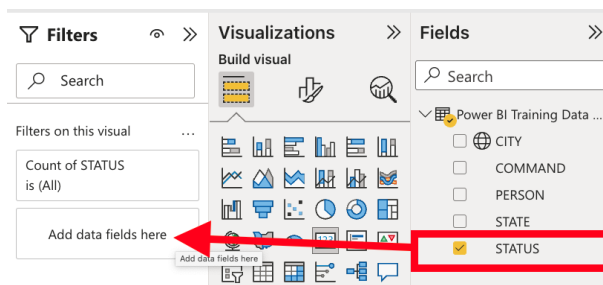
First STATUS should now be populated under *Fields* in the *Visualizations* section.

Under **Fields** on **First STATUS** Click on the **down arrow (V)** and change it to **Count**.

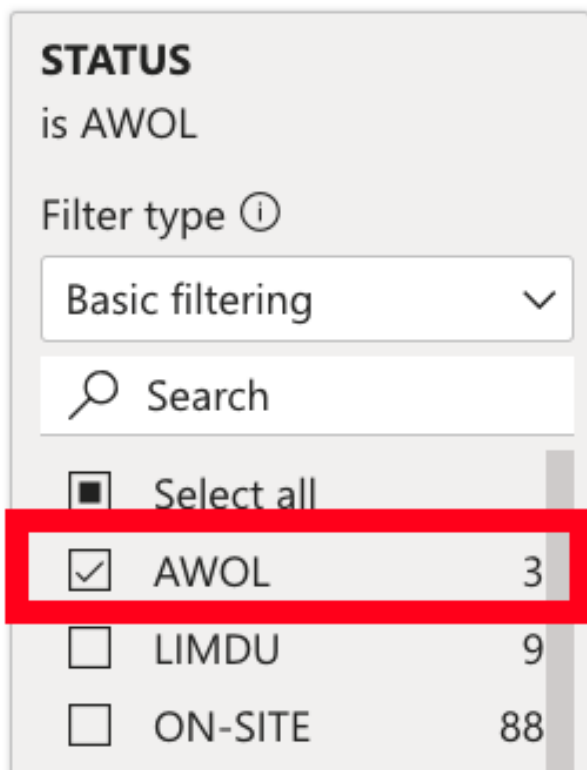


For this visual to display the number of personnel in the AWOL status, we will need to add the *STATUS* Filter to the visual.

1. If not already visible, expand out the **Filters** pane.
2. Under **Data** Click on **STATUS** and **DRAG** it to the **Add Data fields here** area under **Filters on this visual**,

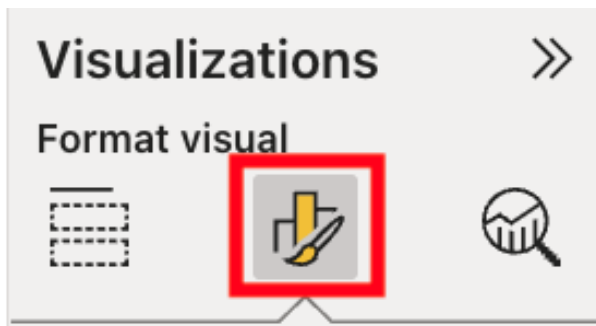


3. In the **Status Filter** pane, under *Basic Filtering*, select **AWOL**

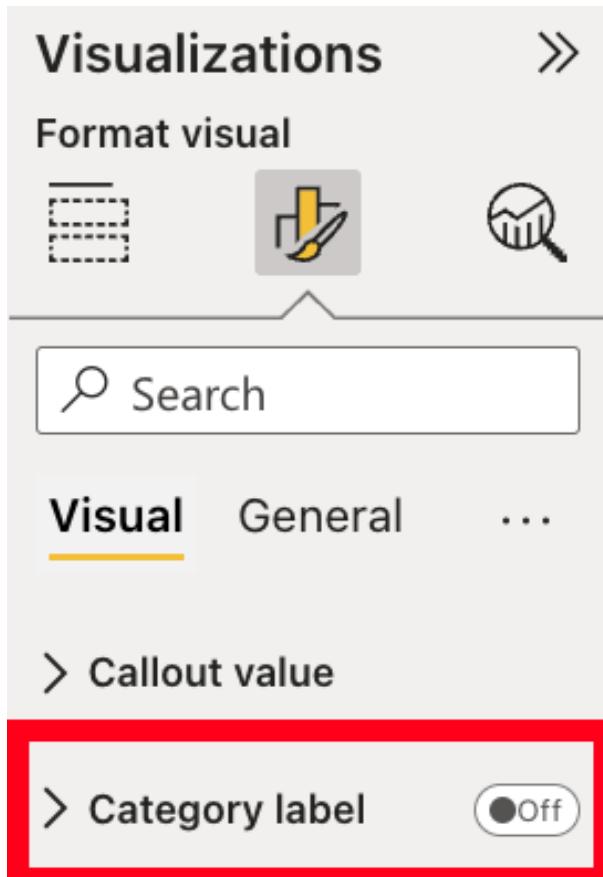


This is great, but it would be easier to understand with a few tweaks to describe what this visual is telling us.

4. Click and select your card, then under *Visualizations*, select the **Format Visual** icon (in the middle).

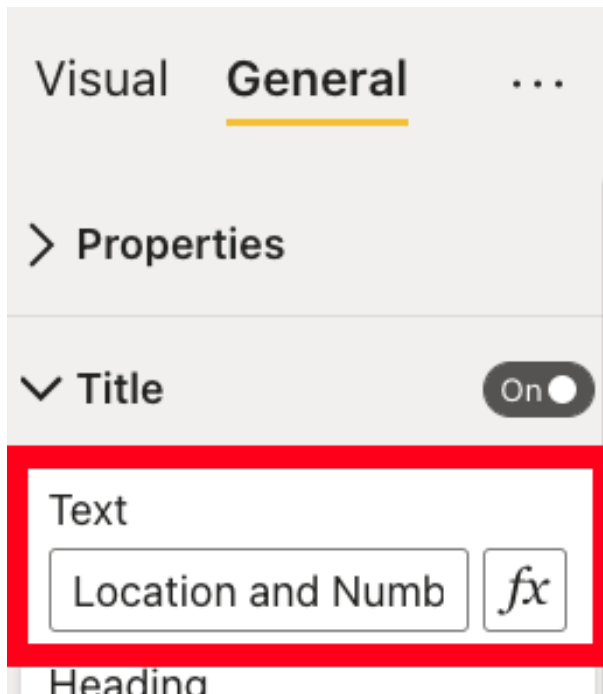


5. Under **Visual** Next to **Category labels** toggle the button to **Off**



6. While we are here, let's give this visual a proper name. Under **Format Visual**, click on **General**.

Then click **the arrow (>)** next to **Title**

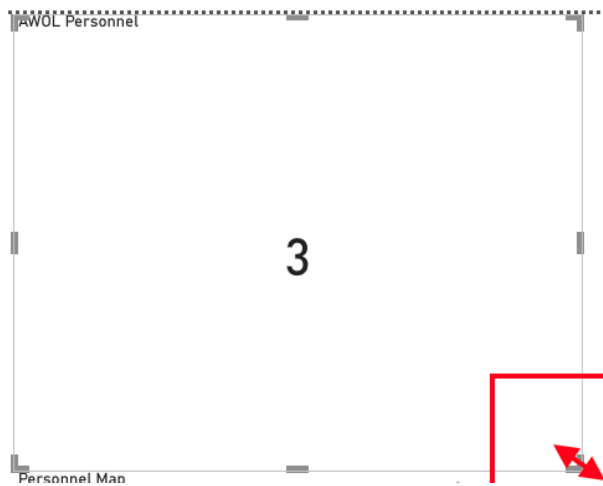


Under **Text** change that to something more meaningful like "**AWOL Personnel**"

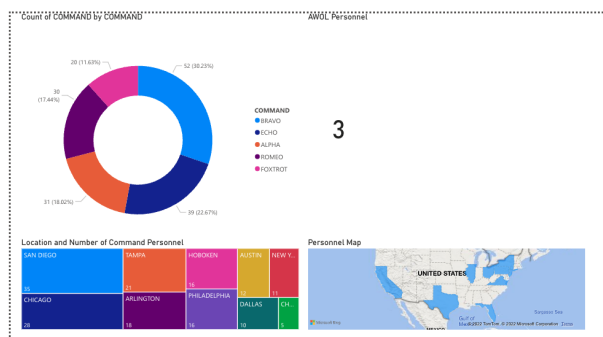
Your card should now have a nice, descriptive title and a sample number.

The card visual is just WAY TOO BIG! Let's resize it so that we can fit one more visual on this report.

1. **Hover your mouse** over the** right corner bracket** of the *AWOL Personnel* card until it changes to an arrow.



2. **Click and hold** while resizing the card to a thin sliver, just wide enough to keep the title on one line.



Layout your visuals: Slicers

Since this will be used by the Command Staff, we want to make it as easy as possible to filter out the data they don't want to see. To do this, we'll create a *Slicer*.

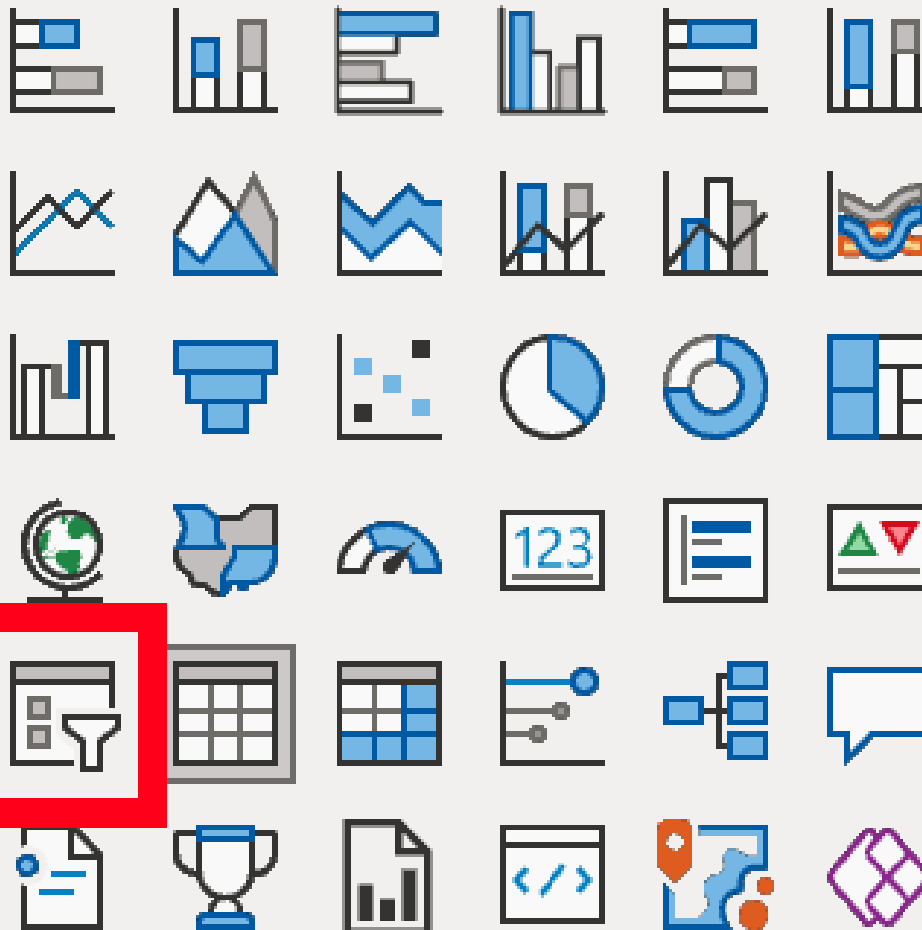
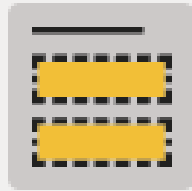
1. Click on a blank area of the report

Under *Visualizations*, select the **Slicer** visual icon

Visualizations

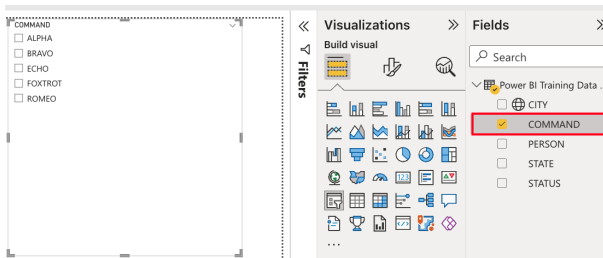


Build visual



...

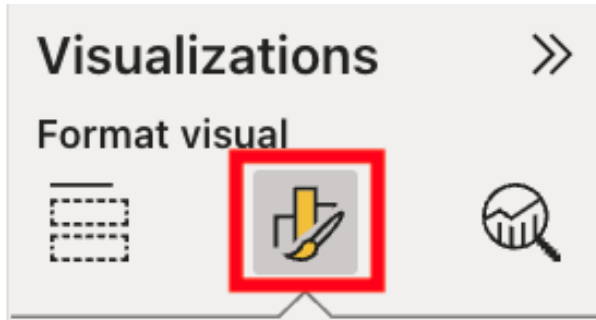
2. With the new **Slicer** visual selected in the report in the report, Under **Data**, click on **COMMAND**.



Your Slicer should now have a selectable list of *COMMANDS*

This is functional, but let's make this a little bit prettier and easier to use.

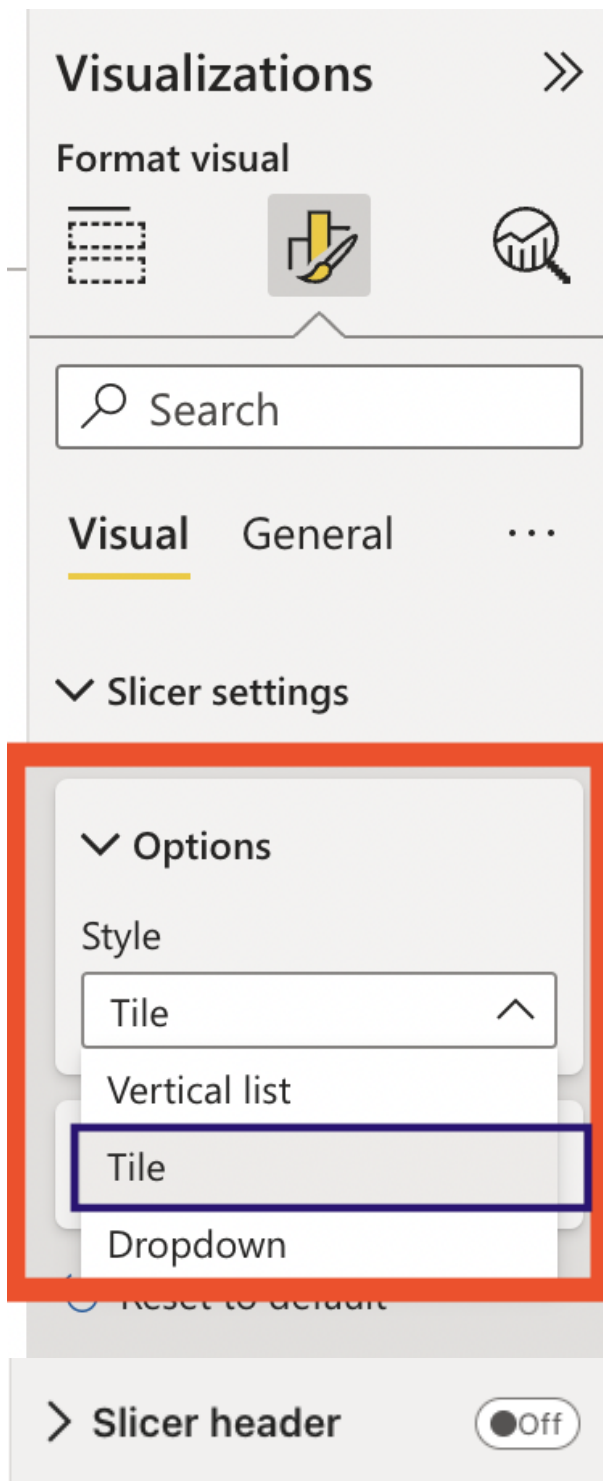
3. Click and select your Slicer, then under *Visualizations*, select the **Format Visual** icon (in the middle).



4. Under **Visual** click the arrow (>) next to **Slicer Settings** then again next to **Options**

5. In the **Options** field, change it to **Tile**

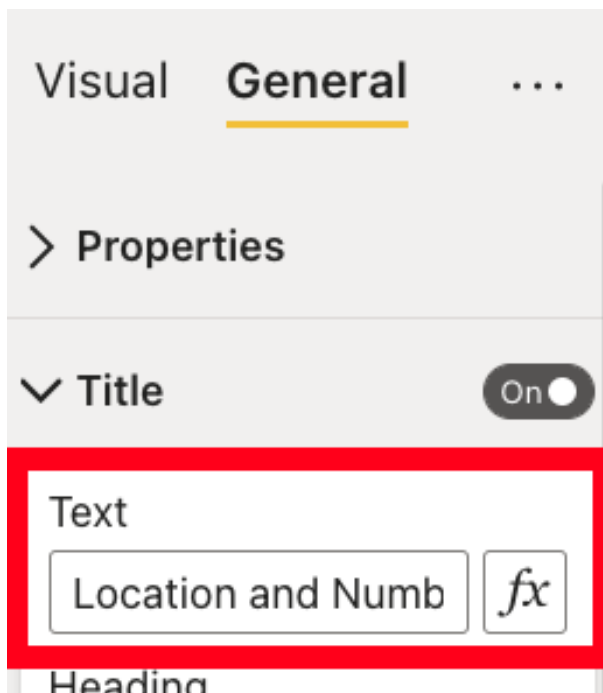
Then toggle the **Slicer Header** to **Off**



While we are here, let's give this visual a proper name. Under **Format Visual**, click on **General**.

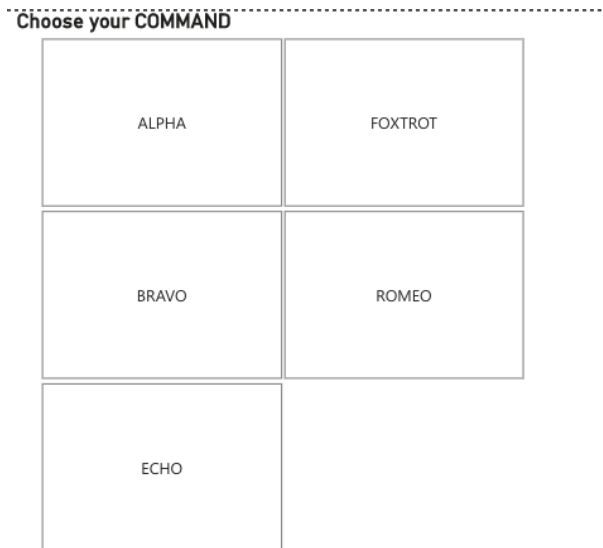
6. Click the toggle next to **Title** to **On**

Then click **the arrow (>)** next to **Title**

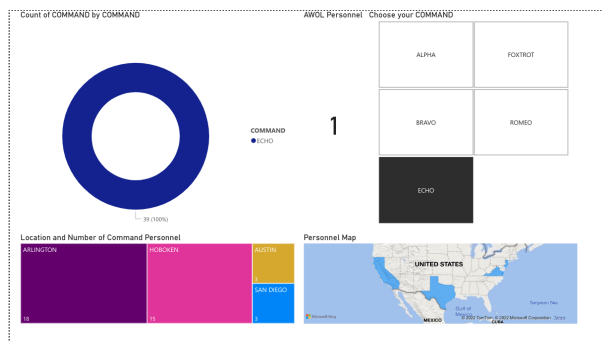


Under **Text** change that to something more meaningful like "**Choose your COMMAND**"

Your Slicer should now have a nice, descriptive title and larger buttons.



Go ahead and click on one of the COMMANDS in your Slicer. You will see the values of your report visuals change.

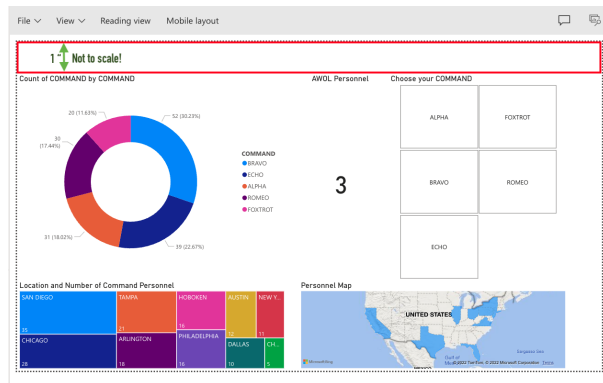


Layout your visuals: Text Labels and Styles

Now for the last few tweaks before we show off our new report. Let's add a descriptive title and some color.

Add a report title text label

We need to make some room on top for our report title. You can click and drag your visuals around the report to make space for the title on the top. Feel free to resize and reposition them as well to suit your preferences. You should have about an inch or so at the top of your report for the next step.

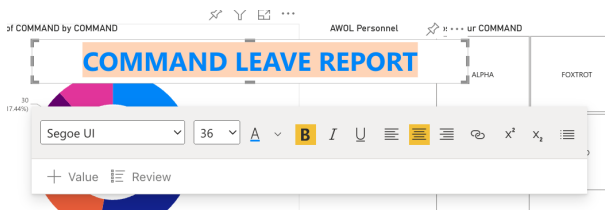


1. On the top menu bar on the right side, click on the **Text Label** icon.

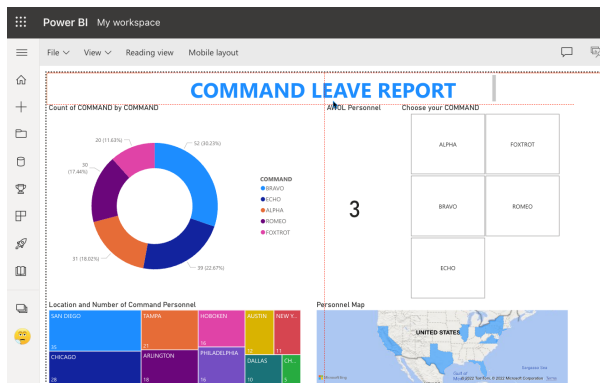


2. Inside the **text box**, click and type in a title for your report. Something like "**Command Leave Report**".

In the Text Label options box, select the **Font**, **Size**, and other formatting options for your title. We recommend making it big and easy to read.



3. Once you are happy with your formatting, move the text label box to the location where you want it on your report. Don't forget that you can use the guide markers to help you center your title.



**Feel free at this time to customize your report as you wish.
Experiment with borders, shadows, and colors. Resize and move your
visuals around. Go nuts! :)**

THIS COMPLETES ACTIVITY #2